4.4. Key SCM metrics: spotting trends in your data

Instead of focusing on LOC, we're going to look at some of the richer data you can get if your team is submitting pull requests and using CI to build and deploy code. We're going to combine that with the data we're already looking at from chapter 3.

We'll look at the following data from our SCM:

- Pull requests
- Denied pull requests
- Merged pull requests
- Commits
- Reviews
- Comments
- CLOC (helps calculate risk)

4.4.1. Charting SCM activity

If you're using standard SCM systems, then you probably already have the basic LOC stats that we discussed earlier. To get some information that can really help you, we'll start off by looking at pull request data to see what that tells you.

If you start off with something simple like the number of pull requests, you simply have to count the requests.

As shown in figure 4.17, if all is well you should have a lot more comments than pull requests. This delta is dependent on how you do pull requests on your team. If you have a team with four to six developers, you may open the pull request to the entire team. In this case you'll probably see something like two to three members of the team commenting on pull requests. If you have a bigger team, then opening the pull request to the entire team may be a bit heavy-handed, so a developer may open it to just four to six people with the intention of getting feedback from two or three peers. However you do it, you should see comments parallel pull requests,